

RSVP Reading: A Quick Introduction

Rapid serial visual presentation, or RSVP, shows text one word at a time in a fixed position. Because your eyes never move, the usual cost of saccades disappears. Many readers can comfortably double their reading speed this way.

The highlighted letter marks the optimal recognition point. Your brain identifies a word fastest when it fixates just left of the word center. Skilled readers exploit this trick constantly, without ever noticing it.

Press S, then click any word to set the starting point of the overlay. Then press play, or hit the space bar, and watch the words flow. The title above is an external link, and the line below jumps straight to the second page.

Jump to page two.

Page Two: More Practice Text

Punctuation matters for pacing. Commas add a short pause, while sentence endings add a longer one. Long words also linger a little more on screen. These small adjustments make the stream feel natural rather than mechanical.

You can drag the overlay anywhere on the page. Your speed and the overlay position are remembered between sessions. Use the arrow keys to step backward or forward, and hold shift to jump between whole sentences. Happy reading!

When hyphenation strikes, readers see broken words split across lines everywhere.

